



FRESHMAN
ACADEMY

INTERNAL GUIDE · FOR MASTER'S PROGRAM MENTORS

Master's Program Mentor Guidelines

For Mentors and the Program Coordinator

How to run weekly sessions, track hours, coordinate the team, and keep every student on pace toward their Master's application deadlines.

VERSION

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1 The Role of the Program Coordinator

The Master's Program Coordinator is responsible for keeping the entire team on pace every single week. This means knowing which hours have been fulfilled, which deadlines are approaching, and making sure every mentor is moving.

Owns the hours file	The coordinator tracks all fulfilled mentor hours in the Master's hours file. Every session must be reflected there.
Runs the Monday check-in	Every Monday, the coordinator sends the weekly message to the group, tags the relevant team members, and outlines the tasks for the week.
Manages deadlines	Deadlines are often set one to two weeks out. The coordinator monitors them and escalates when sessions are at risk of being missed.
First week vs ongoing	The first week message is a detailed briefing with full agendas per mentor. Subsequent weeks are lighter check-ins unless a new phase begins.

2 The Weekly Monday Message

Every Monday, the coordinator sends a structured message to the Master's team group. This message sets the tone and tasks for the week. Below is the format to follow.

Structure of the Monday message

Opening line: Brief team greeting and purpose of the message.

Hours reminder: Remind the team to log all hours in the Master's hours file.

Per mentor block: Tag each mentor, name the student, state the hours, give the deadline, and list the session agenda.

Tone: Friendly but direct. The first week is detailed. Later weeks are a check-in unless something has changed.

3 Sample Monday Message

Use the message below as the template for the first week. Subsequent weeks follow the same structure but can be shorter.

Team,

Below are the Master's Program hours that need to be fulfilled this week.

Please make sure all hours are reflected in the Master's hours file.

1. Dr. Lyusyena @[tag]:

Student: Abror | Hours: 3 | Deadline: [insert date]

Agenda: Main essay for one of the chosen programs.

Within the 3 hours, please:

1. Choose the essay for the program Abror settled on.
2. Ask Abror to complete reflections before the meeting.
3. Ask Abror to produce the first draft.
4. Discuss and confirm the essay structure.
5. Polish the essay as much as possible within the remaining time.

2. Sharof @[tag]:

Student: Abror | Hours: 3 | Deadline: [insert date]

Agenda: Recommendation letters.

Within the 3 hours, please:

1. Identify who will write Abror's recommendation letters.
2. Clarify the main points each letter should cover.
3. Collect the necessary details from Abror.
4. Draft the letters or prepare strong outlines.
5. Polish them as much as possible within the remaining time.

For subsequent weeks

A check-in message is enough: tag each mentor, confirm the hours target for the week, note any deadlines approaching, and ask for an update. Only provide a full agenda again if the student is entering a new phase of work.

4 Session Agenda Format

Each mentor session must have a clear agenda. When writing the agenda for a session block, follow this structure:

- State the **student name**, **number of hours**, and **hard deadline** at the top of every block.
- Name the **primary deliverable** for the session: what must exist or be significantly progressed by the end.
- List **3 to 5 specific steps** the mentor should work through within the session time.
- The final step should always be about **quality and polish**, using whatever time remains.
- Steps should be actionable verbs: Choose, Ask, Draft, Discuss, Confirm, Polish, Review, Submit.

5 Hours Tracking

The coordinator owns the Master's hours file. No session is considered complete until it is logged.

- Every fulfilled session must be entered into the Master's hours file immediately after it occurs.
- The coordinator checks the file at the start of each week and identifies any gaps before sending the Monday message.
- If a mentor has not logged hours from the previous week, the coordinator follows up directly before the group message goes out.
- The hours file is the source of truth. If it is not in the file, it did not happen.

Non-negotiable

The Monday message goes out every week without exception. Even if nothing has changed, a brief check-in must be sent. Silence from the coordinator signals to the team that the week does not matter.

6 Driving the Program, Not Just Managing It

The coordinator's role goes well beyond tracking hours and sending messages. The expectation is that you actively drive the program forward: building community, deepening student commitment, and sharing your own connections and energy.

- **Organise events.** The First Meeting model should be replicated regularly. More community sessions, seminars, and group touchpoints throughout the program.
- **Share connections.** Introduce students to relevant professionals, alumni, and opportunities. Your network is part of the program's value.
- **Build commitment.** Students should feel they are part of something, not just purchasing a service. The coordinator sets that tone.

- **Go beyond the deliverables.** The paid service is the floor, not the ceiling. The best coordinators find ways to add value that were never explicitly promised.

The standard

Delivering what students paid for is the minimum. The goal is a program people talk about, recommend, and remember. That happens through the coordinator's initiative, not through the contract.

7 Interviews and Candidate Assessment

The coordinator conducts intake interviews with prospective Master's Program students. The interview serves two purposes: assessing the candidate's fit and promoting the program. Both must happen in the same conversation.

Tracking and Incentives

- All interviews are tracked in the **Freshman Interviews spreadsheet**.
- Every closed case is logged into the **Master's Application Airtable** by the coordinator.
- The coordinator receives a **\$80 bonus for every closed case**.

Assessing Candidate Strength

Not every applicant is a strong case. The coordinator must be able to distinguish between candidates with genuine motivation and those who are primarily looking for a way to leave the country. The latter is a concern and should be flagged.

Strong case

- Has clear academic or professional goals driving the Master's pursuit.
- Solid GPA and reasonably impressive professional experience.
- Can articulate why a specific program or field matters to them.
- Views the Master's as a step in a larger direction, not an escape.

Weak case

- Primary motivation is leaving the country. No deeper academic or career vision.
- Weak academic background with no compensating professional track record.
- Cannot clearly explain why they want a Master's degree specifically.
- Flag these cases to leadership before proceeding.

8 What We Can and Cannot Guarantee

It is essential that both the coordinator and every mentor communicate this clearly to students from the very first conversation. Do not oversell. Do not imply guarantees that do not exist.

What we can do

- Significantly strengthen the application across multiple fronts.
- Support professional development and positioning.
- Help the student narrow down programs, fields, and goals.
- Build a compelling narrative through essays, CVs, and letters.
- Give the student a real chance at admission with a strong profile.

What we cannot guarantee

- Admission to any specific program.
- Scholarship awards under any circumstances.
- Outcomes that depend on factors outside our control: GPA history, work background, university quotas.

Scholarships in particular are never to be mentioned as a likely outcome.

The standard

A student with a solid GPA and genuinely impressive professional experience has a good chance of getting admitted to a Master's program. That is the honest framing. Scholarship is a separate matter entirely and must never be implied as part of the offer.

9 Contracts and Payment Deadlines

Responsible: Sharofiddin Abdukodirov

Master's Program Mentor

Sharofiddin Abdukodirov is responsible for reviewing all signed student contracts and converting the payment terms into concrete, dated deadlines in the payment tracking spreadsheet. This must be done for every new contract without exception.

Process

- Access the contracts from the **Freshman Contracts folder** on Google Drive.
- For each contract, identify the exact payment amounts, schedule, and any conditions attached.
- Enter each payment as a concrete deadline (specific date and amount) in the **Payment Deadlines spreadsheet**.
- Flag any contract where the payment terms are ambiguous or missing a date, and escalate to leadership.
- Keep the spreadsheet updated as payments are received or dates change.

CONTRACTS

drive.google.com/drive/folders/1CdcdTaLfoX9WFqlm6hz5p1nPZhTjDJbS

PAYMENT DEADLINES

docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1d6yW7v0NR-vvAucbcSv4jbMs5DqpcQPsdXkvdGg__rs

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